

WHEN REALITY INTERSECTS WITH FAITH

TEXT: Hebrews 11:1 (NKJV) *“Now faith is the substance of things hoped for, the evidence of things not seen.”* Hebrews 11:1 (AMP) *“Now faith is the assurance (the confirmation, the title deed) of the things [we] hope for, being the proof of things [we] do not see and the conviction of their reality [faith perceiving as real fact what is not revealed to the senses].”*

INTRO: The way God sees things and the way we see things are very different. God’s thoughts and our thoughts are more times than not, on two different wave lengths:

- God functions in truth, we operate in perception.
- God functions in actuality, we operate in observation.
- God functions in accuracy, we operate by facts.

- God functions in faith, we walk by sight.

When we see things differently than God sees them we often speak out of what we see rather than what we are supposed to know.

This kind of living causes us to say one thing while God is saying something completely different. This causes us to go against faith and operate in doubt.

Operating in doubt introduces dysfunction into our lives and causes faith to plummet, allowing our problems to eclipse our promise.

Prayer and faith carry with them the ability to move what we need, from the Heavenly realm to the natural realm. ***“Life and death is in the power of the tongue.”***

I want us to look at some instances where reality and faith intersect, and the believer

speaks out of reality, when we should be speaking words of faith over the situation.

When confronted with difficulty, reality say's "*It is impossible.*" Listen to what faith say's... Luke 18:27 (NLT) "*What is impossible from a human perspective is possible with God.*"

When we are weary, reality say's "*I am too tired to go on.*" Listen to what faith say's... Matthew 11:28-30 (NLT) "*Come to me, all of you who are weary and carry heavy burdens, and I will give you rest. ²⁹ Take my yoke upon you. Let me teach you, because I am humble and gentle, and you will find rest for your souls. ³⁰ For my yoke fits perfectly, and the burden I give you is light.*"

When we have been betrayed in a relationship, reality say's "*Nobody really loves or cares about me. I must not be good*

enough.” Listen to what faith say’s... John 3:16 (NLT) *“For God so loved the world that he gave his only Son, so that everyone who believes in him will not perish but have eternal life.”* John 13:34-35 (NLT) *“I am giving you a new commandment: Love each other. Just as I have loved you, you should love each other. ³⁵ Your love for one another will prove to the world that you are my disciples.”*

When we have exhausted our resources, reality say’s, *“I can’t go on.”* Listen to what faith say’s... 2 Corinthians 12:9 (NLT) *“My gracious favor is all you need. My power works best in your weakness.”* Psalms 91:15 (NLT) *“When they call on me, I will answer; I will be with them in trouble. I will rescue them and honor them.”*

When we do not know which way to turn, reality say’s, *“What should I do?”* Look at

what faith say's... Proverbs 3:5-6 (NLT)
“Trust in the LORD with all your heart; do not depend on your own understanding. ⁶ Seek his will in all you do, and he will direct your paths.”

When we become weary with doing the right thing, reality say's, *“It's not worth it.”* Look at what faith say's... Galatians 6:9 (NLT) *“Don't get tired of doing what is good. Don't get discouraged and give up, for we will reap a harvest of blessing at the appropriate time.”*

When we have failed, reality say's, *“I can't forgive myself.”* Look at what faith say's... 1 John 1:9 (NLT) *“If we confess our sins to him, he is faithful and just to forgive us and to cleanse us from every wrong.”* Romans 8:1 (NLT) *“There is no condemnation for those who belong to Christ Jesus.”*

When we face financial hardships, reality say's, *"I can't see a way out."* Look at what faith say's... Philippians 4:19 (NLT) ***"God will supply all your needs from his glorious riches, which have been given to us in Christ Jesus."***

When fear presses in on us, reality say's, *"I am afraid of what the future holds."* Look at what faith say's... 2 Timothy 1:7 (NLT) ***"God has not given us a spirit of fear and timidity, but of power, love, and self-discipline."***

When we face situations that are much bigger than we are, reality say's, *"I am not wise enough to negotiate this mess."* Look at what faith say's... James 1:5 (NLT) ***"If you need wisdom—if you want to know what God wants you to do—ask him, and he will gladly tell you. He will not resent your asking."***

PLACES PREACHED:

CT Church Houston 2/16/14 - 9:00 AM
CT Church Gulfgate 2/16/14 – 11:00 AM